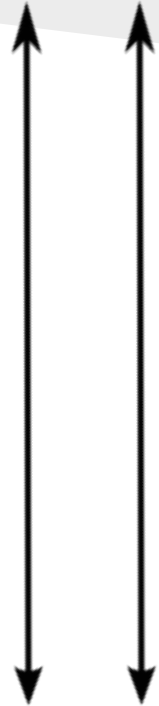


Parallel Structure

By: Jaden Aiona & Cierra Thompson

Definition

Parallel structure is the same pattern of words to show that two or more ideas have the same level of importance.



Rule #1

Parallel structures
must be joined with
conjunctions.

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conjunctions.

Conjunctions:
and
or
but
yet
so

Note: You can use a conjunction or the beginning of a clause before all the verbs/clauses in a sentence or only before the first one.

Words

Verbs: singing, reading, to hike

Adverbs: gracefully, clearly, really loud

Words

Verbs: singing, reading, to hike

Not parallel

Adverbs: gracefully, clearly, really loud

Not parallel

Words

Verbs: singing, reading, to hike

Not parallel

They have different grammatical structures

Adverbs: gracefully, clearly, really loud

Not parallel

They have different grammatical structures

Words

Verbs: singing, reading, to ~~hike~~ **hiking**

Adverbs: gracefully, clearly, really ~~loud~~ **loudly**

Words

Verbs: singing, reading, to hike ~~hike~~ **hiking**

Parallel ✓

They now have the same grammatical structure

Adverbs: gracefully, clearly, really loud ~~loud~~ **loudly**

Parallel ✓

They now have the same grammatical structure

Use it in a sentence

Katy really likes sing**ing**, read**ing** or hike**ing**.

She sings grace**fully**, clear**ly** and loud**ly**.

Use it in a sentence

Katy really likes singing, reading **or** hiking.

^

conjunction

She sings gracefully, clearly **and** loudly.

^

Rule #2

A parallel structure
that begins with
clauses must keep the
same clauses.

Rule #2

A parallel structure that begins with clauses must keep the same clauses.

A clause is a group of related words containing a subject and a verb.

Note: You can use a conjunction or the beginning of a clause before all the verbs/clauses in a sentence or only before the first one.

Clauses

that she may play, that she may make,
to sleep

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that she may play, that she may make,
to sleep

What is listed above are not all clauses

***Remember, clauses contain a subject
and a verb**

Clauses

that she may play, that she may make,
to sleep ~~that she may sleep~~ Correct ✓
subject

“that **she** may verb” is the clause so it
must be used for all of the clauses

Use it in a sentence

When my friend came over to my house, I told her **that she may play** volleyball with my brother and I, **that she may make** dinner with us and **that she may sleep** at my house.

or

When my friend came over to my house, I told her **that she may** play volleyball with my brother and I, make dinner with us and sleepover my house.

Use it in a sentence

When my friend came over to my house, I told her **that she may play** volleyball with my brother and I, **that she may make** dinner with us and **that she may sleep** at my house.

“that she may” is the clause

or

When my friend came over to my house, I told her **that she may** play volleyball with my brother and I, make dinner with us and sleepover my house.

that she may is only at the beginning of the first clause

BOTH ARE CORRECT

Rule #3

When you are listing items, use parallel structure.

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When you are listing items, use parallel structure.

When listing actions, they must be in the same tense in order to be parallel.

Note: You can use a conjunction or the beginning of a clause before all the verbs/clauses in a sentence or only before the first one.

Lists

wearing his Batman costume, phone calls that come from the Commissioner, and saving Gotham City

Lists

**This phrase isn't the
same tense as the others**
wearing his Batman costume, phone calls that
come from the Commissioner, and saving
Gotham City

answering the Commissioner's phone calls

Use it in a sentence

Bruce Wayne enjoys **wearing his Batman costume, answering the Commissioner's phone calls, and saving Gotham City.**
This list is parallel because they are all in the same tense.

Exercises

First correct these words/clauses/lists and then on your own, create a sentence using parallel structure.

Words: climbing, to walk, sleeping, eat, turning

Phrases: Lizzie can play, Lizzie likes to flip, Lizzie can clap, Lizzie can smile

Lists: correct spelling errors, move paragraphs around to organize an essay,
typing an essay

Exercises

Correct these sentences using what you know about parallel structure.

A farmer spends most of his time tilling the soil, sowing the seeds, and feed the cows.

My teacher once said that she was a terrible student because she waited until the last minute to do her work, completed her class work in a careless manner and her motivation was low.

Global warming affects animals, the environment, and is scary.

The Mcdonald's salesman expected that he would present his new product at the next meeting, he would have enough time to show his PowerPoint and people who are interested will ask questions.

The coach was asked to create a game plan quickly, in a detailed manner and efficiently.

How does this help us?

Parallel structure applies to writing and is extremely useful because it helps add clarity to one's writing. Using parallel structure also helps increase the readability of one's writing.

Thank you!